Putting BOSS Online: What You Need and What It Costs

BOSS has two parts. The **venue laptop** runs the competition on the day, with no internet. The **online server** lets teams register and pay before the event, and shows public results afterwards. This paper is about the online server.

The accounts below need a bank card. The organizer types their own card details and passwords, and I never keep them.

Cost in Philippine pesos

DigitalOcean and the domain seller charge in US dollars, so the peso amount depends on the exchange rate on the day you pay. The amounts below use **₱62 to the dollar**. Your card statement may differ by a few pesos.

ITEM	WHAT IT IS FOR	PER MONTH	PER YEAR
Online server, 2 GB size, 1 CPU, 50 GB disk (DigitalOcean, listed at 12 US dollars a month)	Space you rent on DigitalOcean's internet servers to keep the website running 24 hours a day. Teams register and pay on it, and the public sees results on it.	**₱744**	₱8,928
Domain name (.com, GoDaddy)	The website address, for example `boss-bicol.com`, so teams can find the site.	n/a	**₱1,099 (regular price)**
Backup storage (Backblaze B2)	A safe copy of the data kept away from the server, in case the server is lost.	₱0 while the database is small	₱0
Sentry, error tracking (free plan)	Reports errors as they happen, so I can fix a problem before teams complain.	₱0	₱0
UptimeRobot, alerts when the site is down (free plan)	Checks every few minutes that the site is up, and emails you if it is not.	₱0	₱0
Cloudflare, DNS and protection (free plan)	Directs the domain to the server and blocks bad traffic before it reaches the website.	₱0	₱0
Total		**₱744**	**₱10,027**

Domain options at GoDaddy (.com):

OPTION	LENGTH	YEAR 1	YEARS 2 AND 3	TOTAL
Regular	1 year	₱1,099	n/a	₱1,099
Promo	3 years	₱1	₱1,099 each (assumed; read the terms at checkout)	₱2,199

The promo's ₱1 applies to the first year only and needs the 3-year commitment. The yearly total above uses the regular ₱1,099.

- The server price was checked on DigitalOcean's pricing page. The domain price is what GoDaddy showed for a .com.
- Your bank may add a 1% to 3% fee for paying in a foreign currency (about ₱90 to ₱270 a year on the server).
- A new DigitalOcean account sometimes comes with free credit, depending on the offer at the time.